Sales Booking & Fulfilment Workflow Digitization

Business Process Analysis & Solution Discovery

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1. Business Context & Project Objectives

1.1 Current Operational Context

Nippon Toyota handles vehicle sales and fulfilment across 13 branches in Kerala. The process begins with customer enquiry and booking, followed by vehicle allocation, documentation, insurance, invoicing, registration and delivery.

Sales Officers record enquiries through iCrop, which is linked to Toyota's CTDMS. Alongside these systems, physical customer files are maintained with the OBF and supporting documents. After vehicle allocation, the file passes through the Team Leader and Sales Manager for verification and approval before reaching the Back Office.

The Back Office coordinates with Insurance and Accounts to complete the remaining documentation and registration activities. This involves multiple departmental handoffs and the use of both digital systems and physical records.

1.2 Problem Statement

The current process relies heavily on physical customer files and coordination between departments. Documents are manually transferred between Sales, Back

Office, Insurance and Accounts, while customer and vehicle information is entered or updated across multiple systems and forms.

Booking changes during the waiting period also require manual updates and approvals. Certain registration documents require physical signatures, including bank signatures where applicable.

These activities create opportunities for repeated work, delays in document processing and difficulty tracking the current status of a booking. The extent of these issues and their impact need to be assessed through the discovery process.

1.3 Project Objectives & Scope

Objectives

1. Document the complete vehicle sales and fulfilment process, from enquiry to delivery.
2. Understand departmental responsibilities, document requirements and approval points.
3. Identify repeated data entry, manual activities and delays in the existing workflow.
4. Evaluate opportunities to digitize documents, centralize relevant information and improve process tracking.
5. Assess the feasibility of improvements within existing operational and system constraints.

Scope

The study covers the vehicle sales process from customer enquiry and booking through vehicle allocation, documentation, insurance, invoicing, registration and delivery.

The focus is on improving the existing workflow without assuming the replacement of Toyota-managed systems such as iCrop and CTDMS. Any proposed changes will consider existing system dependencies, approval requirements and departmental practices.

2. Discovery Methodology & Stakeholder Analysis

2.1 Discovery Approach

The existing workflow was studied through discussions with employees involved in vehicle sales and fulfilment. The discussions focused on departmental activities, documents handled, approval requirements, system usage and challenges in completing each stage.

Physical OBF forms and customer files were examined to understand the information collected and how documents move between departments. The use of iCrop, CTDMS and the Toyota Portal was also considered as part of the process study.

The information gathered was used to map the current workflow and identify areas requiring further verification.

2.2 Stakeholders & Departmental Responsibilities

Stakeholder	Primary Responsibility

SO	Handles customer enquiries, bookings, OBF and customer documentation.
Cashier	Handles booking fee collection and payment-related records.
TL	Verifies booking documentation and provides the required approval.
SM	Handles vehicle allocation and approval of booking changes.
BO	Coordinates documentation, insurance, invoicing and vehicle registration.
Insurance	Verifies customer and vehicle details and processes insurance documentation.
Accounts	Handles invoicing, FASTag and road tax-related processing.

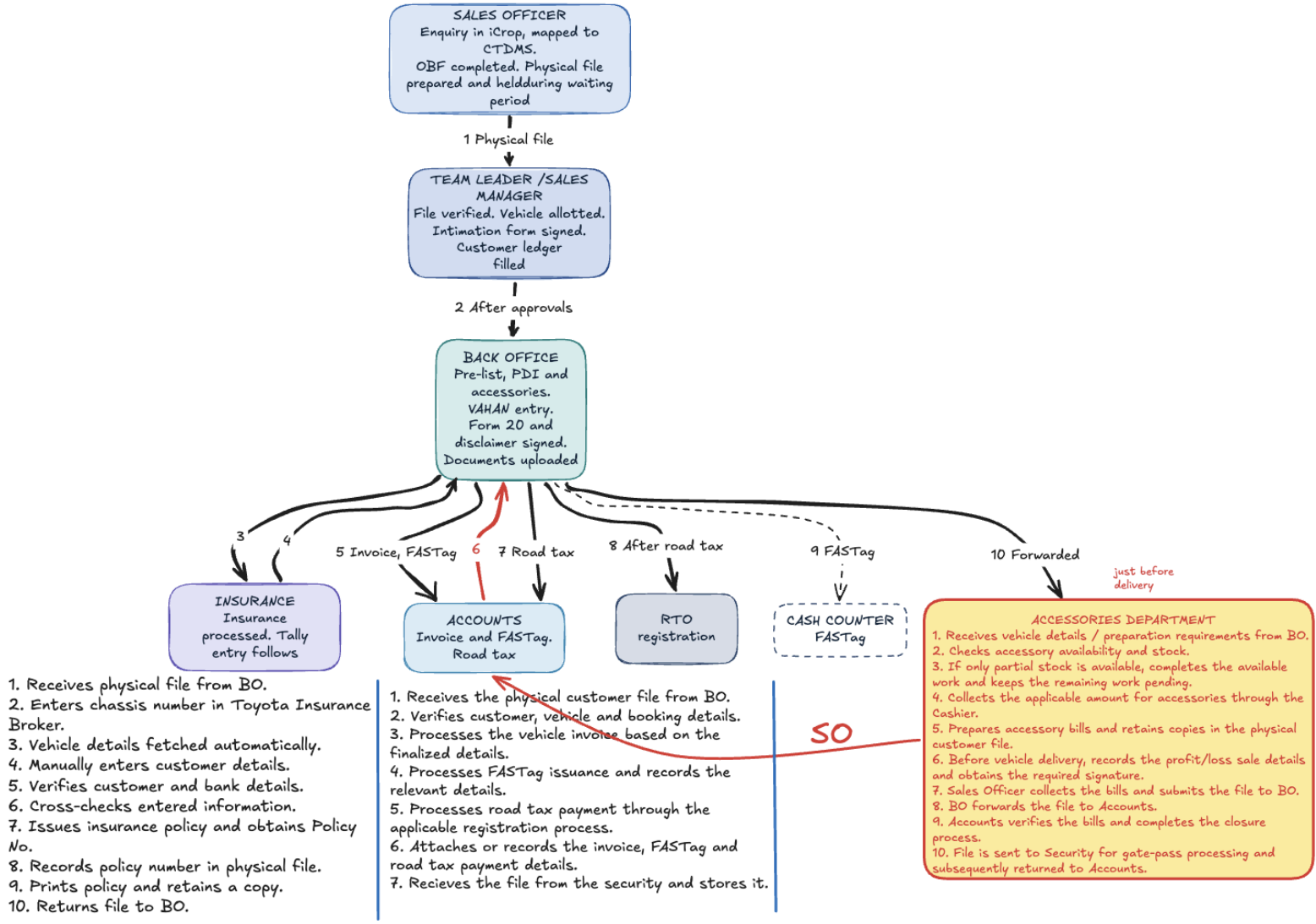
2.3 Interviews, Observations & Evidence Sources

The study draws on the following sources:

1. Discussions with employees involved in Sales, Back Office and Insurance activities.
2. Review of the physical OBF and customer file structure.
3. Observation of document movement and departmental handoffs.
4. Information gathered about iCrop, CTDMS and Toyota Portal usage.
5. Process details shared by employees regarding registration and related documentation.

3. Current-State (As-Is) Process Analysis

3.1 End-to-End Sales Workflow



3.2 Departmental Workflow & Handoffs

Handoff summary

Handoff	Purpose

SO → TL → SM	File verification and approval.
TL → BO	Transfer of completed booking file.
BO → Insurance → BO	Insurance processing and policy documentation.
BO → Accounts→ BO	Invoice, FASTag and road tax processing.
BO → Accessories → SO	Vehicle preparation and accessory coordination.
SO → BO → Accounts	Submission and verification of accessory bills.
Accounts → Security → Accounts	Gate-pass processing and file return.

4. Operational Findings & Bottleneck Analysis

4.1 Key Observations & Identified Pain Points

The process study identified the following areas that may affect operational efficiency:

- **Physical document movement:** Customer files are transferred between Sales, Back Office, Insurance and Accounts.
- **Repeated information handling:** Customer and vehicle details are recorded or updated across multiple systems and physical documents.
- **Manual amendments:** Changes during the vehicle waiting period require updates to physical records and internal approvals.
- **Signature dependencies:** Certain documents require physical signatures from customers or banks, depending on the transaction.

- **Limited process visibility:** Tracking the current status of a customer file requires coordination between departments.

4.2 Process Inefficiencies & Root Causes

Observed Area	Underlying Process Dependency
Repeated document handling	Dependence on a physical customer file across departments.
Repeated information entry	Information maintained across different systems and documents.
Manual booking amendments	Changes recorded and approved through physical documentation.
Processing delays	Dependence on document availability, signatures and interdepartmental coordination.
Status follow-ups	No single shared view of the file's progress across departments has been established.

5. Constraints, Risks & Dependencies

Area	Constraint/Dependency
Existing Toyota Systems	iCrop, CTDMS and Toyota Portal are managed externally. Access to their internal databases and integration capabilities may be limited.
Registration	VAHAN procedures, document formats and RTO

Requirements	requirements must be followed.
Physical Signatures	Customer, bank and other required signatures may still need physical documentation.
Data Security	Customer documents contain sensitive personal information and require controlled access and secure storage.
Departmental Coordination	Changes to the workflow must account for the responsibilities and approval requirements of each department.
Branch Adoption	Any proposed solution must be practical to implement and use across all 13 branches.
Existing Operations	Improvements should avoid disrupting ongoing sales, booking and registration activities.

6. Solution Opportunities & Preliminary Recommendations

6.1 Improvement Opportunities

Based on the current-state analysis, the following opportunities have been identified:

1. **Centralized Booking Information:** Maintain relevant customer, booking and vehicle information in a common system to reduce repeated data entry.
2. **Digital Document Management:** Store booking documents and supporting records digitally, reducing dependence on physical files.

3. **Booking Amendment Tracking:** Record changes to customer details and booking requirements with approval history.
4. **Process Status Tracking:** Provide visibility into the current stage of each booking, including pending documents, approvals and departmental actions.
5. **Departmental Coordination:** Digitize document handoffs and task notifications between Sales, Back Office, Insurance and Accounts.
6. **Document Checklist Management:** Maintain department-wise checklists to track required documents, signatures and completion status.

6.2 Solution Alternatives & Trade-offs

Alternative	Advantages	Limitations
Process Standardization	Low implementation effort. Improves consistency through common checklists and procedures.	Limited reduction in physical paperwork and manual coordination.
Partial Digitization	Digitizes selected activities such as document storage, amendment tracking and status updates.	Physical documents and some manual handoffs will remain.
Centralized Workflow Management System	Provides shared booking information, document management, approval tracking and process visibility.	Higher development and maintenance effort. Requires user adoption and careful handling of existing system dependencies.

7. Conclusion

The study identified opportunities to improve sales and fulfilment workflow through reduced paperwork, better document management and improved departmental coordination.

A phased approach to digitization is recommended, focusing on practical improvements that work alongside existing systems and operational requirements.

The next step is to validate these opportunities and finalize a feasible implementation plan.